Postmortem: March 10 payment delays (INC-2231)
Author: Payments Core team. Published March 17, 2026.
Summary: card payments were delayed for 3 hours and 10 minutes on March 10, 2026.
In total 18,000 payments were delayed.
Root causes: change CHG-1052 enabled fraud-scoring model v3, whose latency was far higher in production than in staging, and change CHG-1047 had reduced the payment-gateway connection pool to 50.
Affected services: payment-gateway, fraud-check, checkout-api. The ledger-service was not affected.
Action items: load-test fraud models before release; alert when the gateway pool is above 80 percent; require Payments Core review for pool size changes.